YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Cinnamon Roll

F C T N

Unhurried swirls of warmth, leads with a hug.

YOUR CODE

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Captain

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Nester

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Story After the Last Story

At bedtime, one story becomes two, then a glass of water, then a question about the moon. You love the warm weight of your child beside you. You also want a shower, ten quiet minutes, and a body that belongs to you again. When you close the book and say, “That's all tonight,” tears appear. Guilt immediately offers another chapter.

As a Cinnamon Roll parent, you wrap discomfort in warmth. You know how to soothe, soften, and make room. But comfort that always costs your last piece of energy eventually stops feeling tender.



Tonight you keep the boundary. “I know you want another one. I'll stay for one hug, and the answer is still finished.” You breathe through the protest instead of bargaining with it.

Later, warm water runs over your shoulders. The house did not become less loving because you ended the ritual. Your child met disappointment and remained accompanied; you met your own need and remained a caring parent. Warm and firm were never opposites. They were always meant to share the same oven.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You instinctively offer hugs, flexibility, and comfort. You can feel guilty whenever you need to disappoint your child or choose a need of your own.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Keeping your child comfortable is not the only form of love. Holding a reasonable boundary, even through protest, is care too.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. World-class comforter
2. Slow mornings are your masterpiece
3. Feelings get talked through over breakfast

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Comfort-first can dodge the hard limits. Warm AND firm can share one oven. 🍯

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Elephant parenting



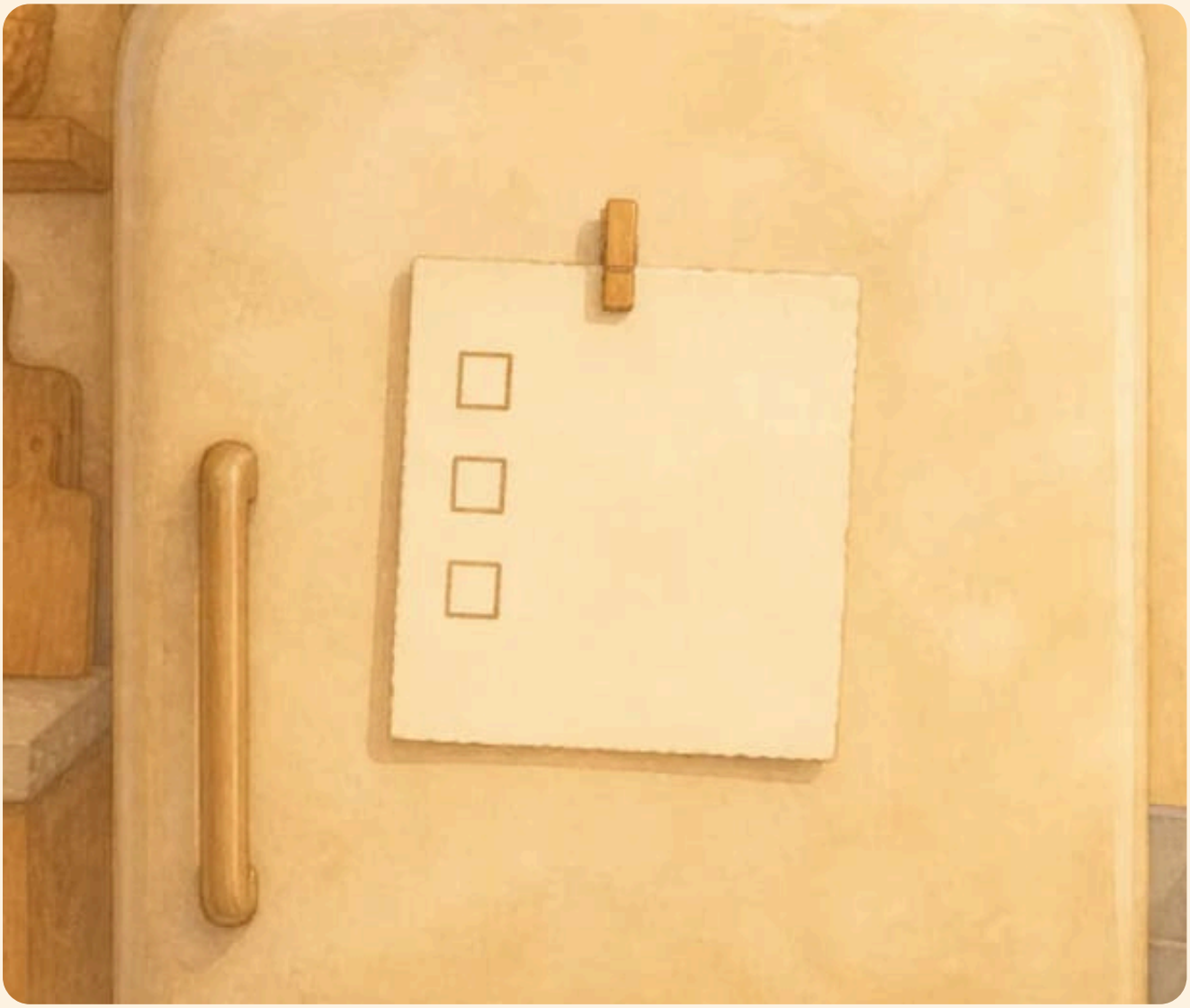
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Hold one small boundary
- [ ] Accept one offer of help without repaying it
- [ ] Say: “I know you really want it. I will stay with the sadness, and the answer is still no.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Write the three things that will definitely happen tomorrow, and stick it on the fridge.
- [ ] Explain one rule once, then stop explaining it.
- [ ] Just once, listen all the way to the end without offering a solution.
- [ ] Hold back one "be careful" today.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Steering. You're the one who always has to know the next move.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Vigilance. Everyone's sense of safety is parked with you.

FOR YOU FIRST

Ask what you want before automatically making everyone else comfortable.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 2 MIN

One anchor for tomorrow

You decide all day because your day has no rail. One fixed point isn't a schedule; it's one less decision.

Pick one thing that will happen at the same time tomorrow. The same breakfast, the same song, the same walk.



TIME 10 MIN

Hand over the wheel for ten minutes

What tires you isn't the work, it's being the one who decides. Ten minutes of not being in charge is real rest.

Let someone else decide something real and small, and do not improve their decision afterwards.



TIME 10 MIN

Ten minutes with no voices

Your ears have been on shift since morning — hearing, naming, soothing. Ten wordless minutes isn't loneliness, it's a break.

No podcast, no music with words, no conversation. Ten minutes.



TIME 10 MIN

One step outside

Your vigilance never clocks out. When another trusted adult takes over, ten minutes outside reminds your body that not everything has to stay under your watch.

Ask another trusted adult to take over, then step outside for ten minutes with your phone still on in your pocket. If you're the only adult home, sit by an open window instead.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child needs your warmth and also the experience that disappointment can be survived without the boundary disappearing.



0–12 MONTHS · 15 MIN

Treasure basket

Real objects are richer than plastic toys, and choosing independently is what makes the concentration last.

1. Fill a shallow basket with 5–6 real objects of different materials: wood, metal, fabric, natural.
2. Sit beside them and let them lead entirely.
3. Resist handing, demonstrating or naming unless they look up at you.

You'll need: A large wooden ring, a fabric square, a short chunky brush, a silicone cup, a metal measuring cup.

Safety first: Every object must be too big for a toilet-paper tube, unbreakable, with no coating that can flake and no cord or long handle.

Grounded in: Heuristic play / treasure basket



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Hand me the laundry

Real work, done together, with no standard to meet. Toddlers want to take part, not to be entertained.

1. Sit by the basket and hand them one item at a time.
2. Let them put it in the machine or the pile.
3. Thank them for the work, not for doing it neatly.

You'll need: The laundry you already have.

Safety first: Machine door closed and off when unattended. Keep detergent capsules completely out of the room.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



2–3 YEARS · 15 MIN

Wash one cup

One whole task with a visible beginning and end. At this age, a finished job means more than praise.

1. Set a low station: bowl, sponge, towel.
2. Demonstrate the sequence once.
3. Leave them to it, including the parts they do badly.

You'll need: A bowl of warm water, a small sponge, one unbreakable cup, a towel.
Safety first: Warm not hot. Soap that doesn't sting eyes. The stool must be stable.
Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

Draw anything, I'll just be here

"What is it?" makes a child guess the answer you want. Describing what you see asks nothing of them.

1. Paper and crayons, both of you at the table.
2. Describe colours, movements, choices — "you used a lot of blue there".
3. Never ask "what is it?", and never correct a colour or a shape.

You'll need: Paper and crayons.
Safety first: Use intact, non-toxic children's crayons. Stay close if your child still puts objects in their mouth.
Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



4–5 YEARS · 10 MIN

One sentence each

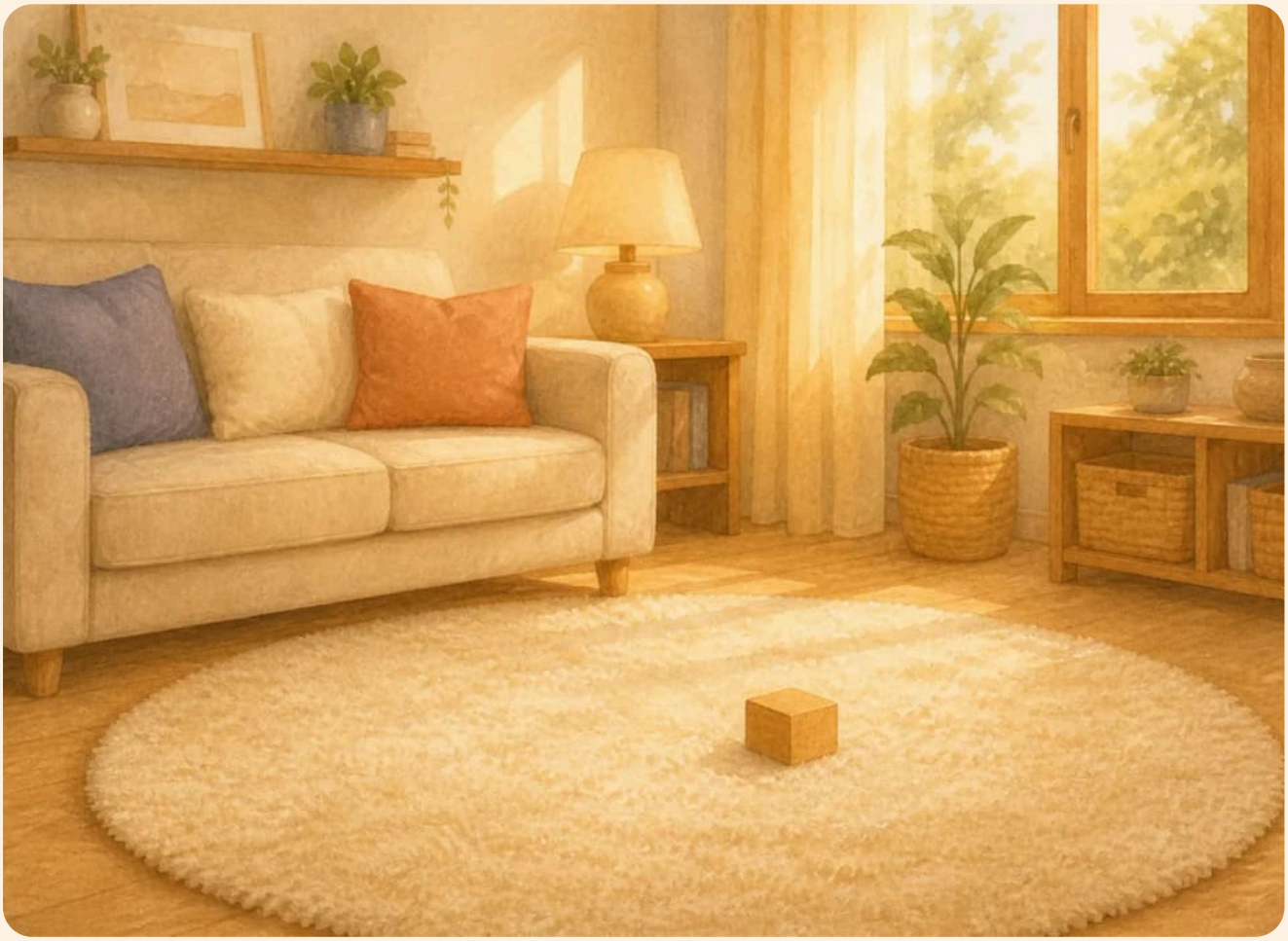
A story built by two people, slowly, before bed. Accepting their turn as it comes is another form of listening.

1. You start with one sentence, they add the next.
2. Accept every turn they take, including the ones that break your plot.
3. When they end it, it's ended.

You'll need: Nothing at all.

Safety first: If the story becomes upsetting, stop or change direction. This is not a test and never needs to be finished.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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